and to launch an operation to trace Pakistani nationals who arrived in India on valid visas.

In the same meeting, a seasoned spy who handled Chinese affairs warned that India needs to brace for aggressive espionage operations from China, especially in the light of China's geo-political ambition to become the pre-eminent power in Asia and a global power by 2050 and its ambitious projects, such as the Belt and Road Initiative (BRI). There are several contentious issues between the two nations that the R&AW is particularly worried about and this reflected in their presentation to Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The unresolved issue of the delineation of the India-China boundary area, lack of progress in clarifying the Line of Actual Control (LAC), China's concern about the presence of the Dalai Lama in India and India's concerns regarding a postDalai Lama scenario all remain a headache for Indian decision makers.

The spies were also worried about Chinese support to certain northeast groups, increased Chinese interests in the Indian Ocean Region, the China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC, a part of BRI), which passes through Pakistan Occupied Kashmir, the encirclement of India through China's string of pearls project and growing Chinese influence in India's neighbourhood, especially in Nepal, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka and the Maldives.

It is an undeniable fact that China is the most active nation in the world with regard to cyber espionage, with formidable capabilities aimed at economic sabotage. Two other modus operandi adopted by China are to exploit business and cultural exchanges to harvest intelligence in India. In fact, the government's top decision makers were given a list of institutes